

# Road to 13

12-week training plan · August 17 – November 8, 2026 · Goal: 13-mile long run, working toward sub-8:00/mile pace

| Aug 17–23     |                                          | ✓ Completed — Target: 12 mi total · 6 mi long run |
|---------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| LONG RUN      | 6 mi easy                                |                                                   |
| TEMPO / SPEED | Skip — travel week                       |                                                   |
| EASY RUNS     | 2 short runs (3–4 mi), fit around travel |                                                   |

*Priority is just not losing the habit. Don't stress about pace.*

| Aug 24–30     |                                                                                                  | ✓ Completed — Target: 23.5 mi total · 10 mi long run |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| LONG RUN      | 10 mi                                                                                            |                                                      |
| TEMPO / SPEED | ~5.5 mi total — 1mi warmup, 3×1mi @ 8:45–9:00/mi w/ 400m jog recovery between reps, 1mi cooldown |                                                      |
| EASY RUNS     | 2 runs, 4–5 mi, easy                                                                             |                                                      |

*Back to normal routine.*

| Aug 31–Sep 6  |                                                                           | ✓ Completed — Target: 23.5 mi total · 11 mi long run |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| LONG RUN      | 11 mi                                                                     |                                                      |
| TEMPO / SPEED | ~4.3 mi total — 1mi warmup, 20 min tempo @ 8:45/mi (~2.3mi), 1mi cooldown |                                                      |
| EASY RUNS     | 2 runs, 4–5 mi, easy                                                      |                                                      |

| Sep 7–13      |                                                                                               | ✓ Completed — Target: 11 mi total · 3.1 mi long run |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| LONG RUN      | None this week — the race is the effort (see Tempo/Speed). Optional easy 2mi shakeout Sunday. |                                                     |
| TEMPO / SPEED | 5K RACE (3.1 mi) — Saturday 9/12. Actual result: 25:01, 7:57/mi pace.                         |                                                     |
| EASY RUNS     | 2 easy runs (3–4 mi) early week (Mon/Tue), light taper                                        |                                                     |

*Taper early in the week, race Saturday, recover Sunday, back to normal volume next week.*

| Sep 14–20     |                                                                                                             | Target: 22 mi total · 10 mi long run |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| LONG RUN      | 10 mi — easing back in, should feel recovered by now                                                        |                                      |
| TEMPO / SPEED | ~4 mi total — 1mi warmup, 15 min @ 8:42–8:50/mi (recalibrated from actual 5K result: 7:57/mi), 1mi cooldown |                                      |
| EASY RUNS     | 2 runs, 4–5 mi, easy                                                                                        |                                      |

First week back to full volume after the race. Resume structured tempo work here.

| Sep 21–27     |                                                                                                          | Target: 26 mi total · 13 mi long run |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| LONG RUN      | 13 mi — first time at goal distance, go slow, just finish                                                |                                      |
| TEMPO / SPEED | ~5 mi total — 1mi warmup, 25 min tempo @ 8:22–8:30/mi (recalibrated from actual 5K result), 1mi cooldown |                                      |
| EASY RUNS     | 2 runs, 4–5 mi, easy                                                                                     |                                      |

| Sep 28–Oct 4  |                           | Target: 20 mi total · 9 mi long run |
|---------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| LONG RUN      | 9 mi                      |                                     |
| TEMPO / SPEED | 3 mi easy, no hard effort |                                     |
| EASY RUNS     | 2 runs, 4 mi, easy        |                                     |

Cutback week.

| Oct 5–11      |                                                                                           | Target: 30 mi total · 12 mi long run |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| LONG RUN      | 12 mi                                                                                     |                                      |
| TEMPO / SPEED | ~8 mi total — 1mi warmup, 5×1mi @ 8:15/mi w/ 400m jog recovery between reps, 1mi cooldown |                                      |
| EASY RUNS     | 2 runs, 5 mi, easy                                                                        |                                      |

| Oct 12–18     |                                                                           | Target: 28.5 mi total · 13 mi long run |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| LONG RUN      | 13 mi                                                                     |                                        |
| TEMPO / SPEED | ~5.5 mi total — 1mi warmup, 30 min tempo @ 8:15/mi (~3.6mi), 1mi cooldown |                                        |
| EASY RUNS     | 2 runs, 5 mi, easy                                                        |                                        |

| Oct 19–25     |                    | Target: 22 mi total · 10 mi long run |
|---------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------|
| LONG RUN      | 10 mi              |                                      |
| TEMPO / SPEED | 4 mi easy          |                                      |
| EASY RUNS     | 2 runs, 4 mi, easy |                                      |

*Cutback week.*

| Oct 26–Nov 1  |                                                                                              | Target: 29.5 mi total · 13 mi long run |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| LONG RUN      | 13 mi, last 3 mi @ 8:00–8:15/mi                                                              |                                        |
| TEMPO / SPEED | ~6.3 mi total — 1mi warmup, 6×800m @ 7:50/mi w/ 400m jog recovery between reps, 1mi cooldown |                                        |
| EASY RUNS     | 2 runs, 5 mi, easy                                                                           |                                        |

*Combining endurance work with goal pace.*

| Nov 2–8       |                                         | Target: 17 mi total · 8 mi long run |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| LONG RUN      | 8 mi easy — taper begins, save the legs |                                     |
| TEMPO / SPEED | 3 mi easy, no hard effort               |                                     |
| EASY RUNS     | 2 runs, 3–4 mi, easy                    |                                     |

*First taper week for the Nov 14 half. Volume drops on purpose — nothing here makes you fitter, it protects what's already banked.*

| Nov 9–15      |                                                                                                                                                          | Target: 19 mi total · 13.1 mi long run |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| LONG RUN      | None separate — the half marathon IS the long run this week                                                                                              |                                        |
| TEMPO / SPEED | HALF MARATHON (13.1 mi) — Saturday 11/14, Novant Health Charlotte Marathon, 7:20 AM. Target: sub-9:00/mi overall (under 1:57:59). This is the goal race. |                                        |
| EASY RUNS     | 2 short easy runs (2–3 mi) Mon/Tue only, full rest Wed–Fri                                                                                               |                                        |

*Race week. Flat, fast course through Uptown/Dilworth/NoDa. Forecast averages 44–61°F — should be ideal racing weather after a summer of heat.*

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Weekly targets assume the low end of any easy-run range (e.g. 4 of a stated "4–5 mi") to leave room for real-life adjustment — hitting the low end still counts as on track. Tempo/Speed distances include warmup and cooldown, not just the main set.